

Experiment 3 – Qualys Cloud Agent Deployment on Windows

OBJECTIVE

To install and activate the Qualys Cloud Agent on a Windows endpoint and verify that the endpoint communicates successfully with the Qualys Cloud Platform.

REQUIREMENTS

- Qualys Cloud Platform account
- Cloud Agent access
- Windows endpoint
- Cloud Agent activation key
- Windows Cloud Agent installer
- Administrator privileges on the Windows endpoint
- Internet connectivity

DETAILED STEPS

1. Log in to the Qualys Cloud Platform with an account that has Cloud Agent access.
2. Open the Cloud Agent module and navigate to the activation-key section.
3. Create a new activation key or select the activation key provided for the practical.
4. Record the activation-key information securely. Do not expose a real key in the lab record.
5. Download the appropriate Windows Cloud Agent installer from the Qualys platform.
6. Copy the installer to the Windows endpoint if it was downloaded on another system.
7. Run the installer using administrator privileges.
8. Follow the installation wizard and complete the required installation options.
9. Use the activation information required by the installer or deployment method to associate the endpoint with the Qualys subscription.
10. Allow the installed service/agent to start and communicate with the Qualys Cloud Platform.
11. Wait for the endpoint to perform its initial check-in.
12. Return to the Qualys Cloud Agent inventory.
13. Search for the Windows endpoint by hostname, IP address or other available identifying information.
14. Open the endpoint details and inspect the agent state, host information and last check-in information.
15. Confirm that the endpoint is registered and visible in the Cloud Agent inventory.
16. Record the agent state and relevant endpoint details in the practical record.

ACTIVATION KEY

An activation key is used to associate the deployed Cloud Agent with the appropriate Qualys subscription/configuration during onboarding.

OBSERVATION

The Windows endpoint becomes manageable from the Qualys Cloud environment after successful installation, activation and communication. The inventory provides visibility into the registered endpoint and its agent status.

CONCLUSION

The practical demonstrates endpoint onboarding through a Qualys Cloud Agent. Successful registration establishes communication between the Windows endpoint and the Qualys Cloud Platform and provides a foundation for agent-based security monitoring and assessment.